

The Gambler-KR -- The Gambler by Kenny Rogers

The Gambler, 1978. ~104 BPM, est.

This is a story-song, not a groove showcase -- the bass job is to sit under Rogers' vocal and keep the train-track rhythm moving without drawing attention to itself. Warm, round, steady. No drive anywhere.

GP-5 only, Sire fretless (Passive), no pedalboard.

IR: TC410 (Slot 9) + AMP: Foxy Bass

TC Electronic BC 410 -- flat, neutral response with a mild 100Hz boost. No editorializing on the tone, which is exactly what a song this simple needs.

Paired with Foxy Bass (Vox AC-100 voicing) for amp character: warm without being hi-fi, no gain stage to fight.

- AMP VOL: 65
- AMP Bass: 60 -- enough low end to anchor the train-beat pulse without getting boomy.
- AMP Treble: 45 -- kept low on purpose. This isn't a bright, modern bass tone; it's a laid-back late-70s country ballad.
- CAB (User IR 9) VOL: 60

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 20. Light touch -- just enough to clean up noise floor on a passive fretless, nothing aggressive since there's no gain stage generating hiss.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 35 when engaged.

Off for the verse-groove storytelling sections, on for the "know when to hold 'em" chorus hook -- same amp tone throughout, just a touch louder and more present for the hook line.

DST -- off.

No drive on this patch. The song is warm and clean start to finish.

AMP -- Foxy Bass, always on. **CAB -- User IR 9 (TC410)**, always on.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1, always on.

33Hz: +3, 150Hz: +4, 600Hz: -2, 2kHz: -3, 8kHz: +2, VOL: 50.

Small low-end reinforcement at 33/150Hz for warmth and weight, a gentle scoop through 600Hz-2kHz to keep things from getting boxy/honky, and a small lift at 8kHz so fretless finger attack still reads clearly against the vocal.

MOD -- off. No modulation -- this tone stays simple and direct, not textural.

DLY -- off. Straight, steady part. No delay.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 20, Decay: 35, Trail: true.

Off for the verses -- dry, close, intimate storytelling tone.

On for the chorus hook, alongside the boost -- a little more air and size without turning into a wash.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- verse/storytelling sound. Dry, warm, understated. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- chorus hook sound ("know when to hold 'em"). Boosted front end plus a touch of room reverb, same amp tone, slightly bigger for the hook line.

This song doesn't ask for a dramatic split -- the whole point is restraint -- so the CTL move here is small on purpose. Engage going into the chorus hook, back off for verses.